

An Exploratory Study of Roblox Games as a Medium for Da'wah and Dissemination Strategies through Social Media

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ABSTRACT

The rapid development of digital technology has opened new opportunities for Islamic da'wah, including within online gaming environments, allowing young generations to interact and interpret religious messages virtually. This study aims to understand Islamic da'wah practices on Roblox and how young users perceive and disseminate religious messages. A qualitative case study approach was employed, involving digital observation, content documentation, and interaction analysis among avatars within the Roblox platform. Findings reveal diverse da'wah activities, such as virtual study sessions, worship simulations, and Islam-themed roleplay communities, which are shared on social media, particularly TikTok, generating high engagement through likes, comments, and shares. Immersive in-game interactions combined with cross-platform dissemination effectively extend the reach of da'wah messages. Positive responses from both youth and parents indicate that adapting traditional da'wah to virtual spaces is effective, establishing a game-based da'wah model relevant to the digital cultures of Generations Z and Alpha. In conclusion, integrating Roblox and social media creates a participatory, effective, and culturally relevant da'wah model for today's digital youth.

Keywords:

Digital Da'wah, Roblox, Social Media, Generation Z, Online Games

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A. INTRODUCTION

The development of digital technology has drastically transformed the landscape of human social life, including the religious sphere (Mahmud, 2024). In this era, da'wah is no longer confined to the pulpit, mosques, or conventional media, but has entered virtual spaces that were previously unimaginable as sites for religious outreach. Social media, video channels, podcasts, and entertainment platforms such as online games have now become part of the digital da'wah



ecosystem (Kusumawati et al., 2022). This phenomenon aligns with the shift from traditional da'wah to cultural and participatory da'wah, in which religious messages are delivered through creative, contextual approaches (Irawan, 2025). Ideally, digital da'wah can address contemporary challenges while presenting Islamic values through communication styles relevant to younger generations (Budiantoro, 2017; Rahmawati et al., 2024).

One digital platform widely used by the younger generation is Roblox (Yuliastika, 2023), which is not merely a game but a user-generated virtual world that allows users to build environments, interact in real-time, and participate in digital communities (Fatonah, 2024). Roblox offers opportunities for digital da'wah due to its participatory and collaborative nature, although da'wah institutions remain necessary to legitimize values and guide activities so that they do not merely serve as entertainment. The popularity of Roblox among Generation Alpha and Z (Malelak et al., 2024), as well as its utilization in other countries, such as Malaysia, for community-based religious activities (Razak et al., 2025), highlights its potential as a relevant medium for da'wah that integrates with youth digital culture. Studies also indicate its effectiveness as a collaborative learning space (Han & Liu, 2023), alongside opportunities and challenges in educational practices and virtual cultural exploration (Alhasan, 2023; Long, 2019; Kang Choi, 2022; Sopiandi, II, 2022; Rospigliosi, 2022).

Da'wah in virtual spaces such as Roblox utilizes various digital platforms to reach broader audiences, including websites, social media, and mobile applications, to disseminate Islamic teachings (Salih et al., 2019). The concept of e-da'wah emphasizes the use of information and communication technology for the spread of religious outreach, which has been studied in terms of its effectiveness and reception in Southeast Asia (Prabowo et al., 2023). Social media, such as WhatsApp, has also been used effectively, as exemplified by the One Day One Juz (ODOJ) movement encouraging Qur'an reading (Nisa, 2018) and by female preachers in Aceh employing social media to expand the reach of their da'wah (Sari & Sikumbang, 2025). Virtual worlds and the metaverse, including Roblox, offer interactive spaces for creative expression and immersive learning, such as graffiti or virtual reality in da'wah (Byeon & Yu, 2023; Corness et al., 2024). Roblox enables the creation of interactive Islamic content, such as virtual mosques and educational games, with real-time user engagement, while still requiring attention to accuracy, the balance of education and entertainment, and ethical considerations (Casas et al., 2025; Al-Zaidi et al., 2025).

Modern da'wah plays a vital role in fostering youth solidarity and harmony by emphasizing innovative approaches, communication effectiveness, and adaptability to social and technological developments (Jannah, 2023). Da'wah strategies on digital platforms such as YouTube demonstrate the effectiveness of religious message delivery, youth audience engagement, and the adaptation of traditional methods to the modern virtual era (Muharrifah & Sikumbang, 2025). Utilizing digital media as a da'wah tool also serves as an important means of disseminating Islamic values online, increasing youth participation, and aligning mosque activities with virtual developments (Kholifah & Hikmah, 2024). Additionally, Instagram has been used as a medium for mosque da'wah to disseminate religious messages, enhance congregation interaction, and adapt traditional da'wah methods to modern digital platforms (Maolana et al., 2024). The da'wah strategy of Ustadz Muhammad Nuzul Dzikri on Instagram emphasizes engaging digital content, interactive approaches, and the effectiveness of virtual da'wah for contemporary society (Maharani & Asia, 2024).

Based on this literature review, this study aims to understand Roblox as a digital da'wah medium, distinct from previous research. First, the study views Roblox not merely as an educational platform but as a space for da'wah, where Islamic values are conveyed through simulations, community activities, and immersive experiences. Second, this research conceptualizes the phenomenon as a form of game-based da'wah, where religious outreach occurs through play experiences and active user participation. Third, it examines how da'wah activities on Roblox are extended through transmedia dissemination strategies on TikTok and other social media platforms, thus creating an integration between participatory virtual spaces and digital media consumption spaces. This interdisciplinary approach strengthens the study's position as a novel contribution to digital da'wah research relevant to youth popular culture, while addressing a gap in the literature on the use of community-based online games as contemporary da'wah media.

B. RESEARCH METHODS

This study employs a descriptive qualitative approach to gain an in-depth understanding of the patterns of digital da'wah on the Roblox gaming platform, as well as how these activities are perceived and interpreted by players, particularly those from Generations Z and Alpha. A descriptive qualitative approach was chosen because it allows the researcher to capture the dynamics of interaction, symbols, and religious practices that naturally emerge within a game-based virtual environment, while providing contextual insight into the social and cultural processes shaping digital da'wah practices.

Data collection methods combine digital participatory observation and social media content analysis. Observations were conducted from July to September 2025 within the Istiqblok community, led by the young creator Kadam Sidiq. The researcher assumed the role of a Roblox user to observe various religious activities, including short studies, virtual Qur'an recitations, religious conversations, and community interactions that foster participatory da'wah practices. Observations were conducted systematically and documented through screenshots, field notes, and monitoring of avatar interactions occurring within the server.

In addition to in-game observations, the study analyzed da'wah content disseminated through social media, particularly TikTok. The first five videos featuring Kadam Sidiq's da'wah activities on Roblox were selected using purposive sampling, based on their initial virality and audience response. These videos were considered representative of the early phase of Roblox-based da'wah, before the influence of social media algorithms or the expansion of more complex narratives. To broaden the perspective, the study also reviewed content from the international Muslim Roblox community, which consistently produces religious activities within the game. Selection criteria included the presence of avatar interactions, religious activities, audience responses, and thematic consistency with Islamic values.

Research informants were Roblox players actively involved in digital religious activities. Data were collected non-intrusively to protect privacy, with identities and avatars anonymized. The study adhered to digital research ethics, avoided collecting personal data from minors, and emphasized that the data would be used solely for academic purposes. Data analysis was conducted through thematic analysis. The first stage, open coding, was used to identify units of meaning from observations and digital content, including avatar interaction patterns, religious message delivery, Islamic symbols, and role-play-based religious practices. The second stage,



axial coding, grouped codes into categories such as “participatory da’wah,” “virtual worship spaces,” “digital religious authority,” and “audience response.” The third stage, selective coding, developed overarching themes that comprehensively explain the Roblox da’wah phenomenon. Source triangulation was applied by comparing observational data, social media content, and relevant literature to enhance the credibility of the findings and minimize interpretive bias.

C. RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

1. The Context of Da’wah in Virtual Worlds and the Potential of Online Game Media

In this study, the term *game-based da’wah* refers to the strategy of conveying Islamic messages through interactive, immersive, and participatory digital gameplay, allowing audiences to experience da’wah directly via simulations, roleplay, avatars, and virtual communities (Nazihah, 2019). This approach has emerged alongside digital transformation, which has altered patterns of religious communication and necessitated the recontextualization of da’wah to align with the digital culture of younger generations (Kahfi, 2025; Fitra, 2023). Roblox, a popular user-generated content platform since 2006, is now utilized by Muslim creators for virtual studies, Qur’an recitations, and worship simulations through its interactive features (Imania, 2025; Lee, 2024). This phenomenon is relevant considering that adolescents spend an average of 5–7 hours per day in digital spaces (Malelak et al., 2024). The gaming world, as a social medium, holds transmedial da’wah potential through gamification and experience-based learning (Limantara et al., 2017; Prayogi, 2021; Asmarita, 2024; Safriani, 2015).



This approach reinforces the concept of participatory da’wah, where children and adolescents are not merely recipients but active, creative subjects engaged in conveying Islamic values. This model aligns with dialogic communication approaches that emphasize two-way engagement in social transformation (Asmarita, 2024). The use of Roblox as a da’wah medium also demonstrates that virtuality does not negate spirituality; rather, it becomes a new medium for internalizing noble values in ways closer to young people's daily realities.

Virtual da’wah should also be understood as a response to the limitations of conventional da’wah models (Irawan, 2025). Amidst the era of globalized values and digital disruption, traditional da’wah approaches characterized as one-way, top-down, and spatially limited have proven less effective in reaching a generation accustomed to digital interaction, visualization, and personalized experiences (Annafsa et al., 2025). In this context, virtual da’wah offers a solution by presenting Islam in adaptive, context-specific formats (Kahfi, 2025). Technologies such as online games, virtual reality, or metaverse

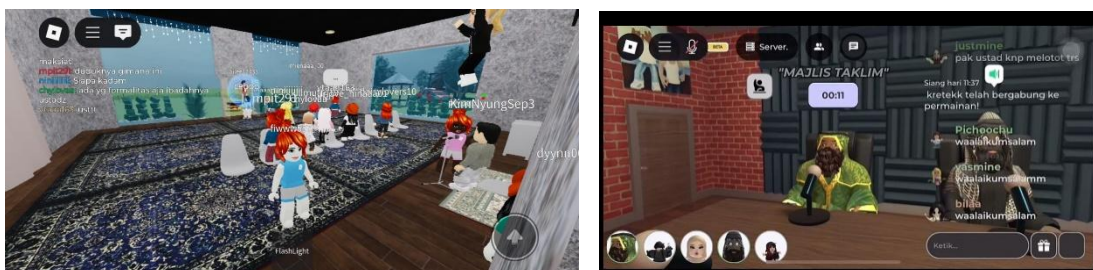
spaces are not merely tools but also environments that shape thinking, interaction, and understanding of spirituality (Al Fajar & Al Kahfi, 2024).

From a symbolic interactionism perspective, one interesting aspect of digital da'wah practices on Roblox is how players produce and negotiate religious meanings through visual symbols in the virtual world. Some Muslim creators use map-making tools to create representations of sacred spaces such as the Ka'bah, Masjid al-Haram, and the Sa'i area. These spaces function not only as visual elements but as symbols through which players form religious identities and engage in ritualistic interactions within the virtual world (Setianto, 2015). For instance, players often move their avatars around the Ka'bah, sit in circles for "study sessions," or perform specific emotes during Qur'an recitation. Such actions establish interaction patterns that produce religious meaning through virtual bodies (avatars), consistent with symbolic interactionist theory, which posits that meaning emerges through repeated, collectively interpreted interactions.

From the perspective of mediatization, this phenomenon illustrates how digital media not only convey religious messages but also reshape how players experience and express religiosity. Da'wah spaces in Roblox are hybrid: on one hand, they emulate familiar ritual symbols (such as the Ka'bah or mosque); on the other, they follow the logic of digital media and gaming culture, such as the use of avatars, game mechanics, and the redistribution of activities to TikTok. This integration shows that religious experiences on Roblox are heavily influenced by media representation models and players' mediatized practices (Qadaruddin, 2018). Thus, da'wah within the gaming world is not merely about content delivery but a process of meaning negotiation shaped by player interactions, virtual symbols, and social media algorithms. This approach allows for a deeper analysis than merely viewing Roblox as an educational medium, focusing on how religious meaning is constructed, negotiated, and disseminated through the digital media ecosystem.

2. Da'wah Practices on the Roblox Gaming Platform

The rapid development of virtual worlds has shifted the paradigm of da'wah delivery from physical spaces to more open, inclusive, and interactive digital spaces (Kusumawati, 2023). Based on the author's analysis, one concrete manifestation of this transformation can be seen in the use of online gaming platforms such as Roblox, which are increasingly employed by young da'is to convey Islamic values to digital-native generations, particularly children and adolescents. As a user-generated content platform, Roblox allows its users to construct their own virtual worlds, interact through avatars, and create rich social experiences (Yuliastika, 2023), making it a potential space for disseminating Islamic values through participatory and contextual approaches.



In the context of contemporary digital da'wah, Husein Basyaiban emerges as a

pioneer utilizing Roblox to deliver Islamic messages creatively and in ways relevant to youth culture. Based on content posted to his official TikTok and Instagram accounts, Husein launched a virtual community called Istiqblok. This community was designed as a game-based da'wah space integrating educational, spiritual, and social elements into a single digital ecosystem. Through Istiqblok, Husein created a dedicated Roblox server that serves as a platform for Islamic studies, virtual sermons, Islamic podcasts, and character development through collaborative user interactions. From the perspective of the mediatization of religion, Istiqblok demonstrates that da'wah is not merely transferred to digital media but is also reshaped by media logic, game mechanics, and patterns of interaction in technology-mediated virtual worlds.

In an increasingly digitalized da'wah landscape, online gaming platforms such as Roblox open new spaces for da'is to deliver Islamic values contextually and interactively (Kahfi, 2024). As a user-generated content platform, Roblox enables users to create virtual worlds, design avatars, and build real-time social interactions, making it more than just a form of entertainment (Nanda et al., 2019). Da'wah on Roblox does not occur through one-way lectures but through experience-based approaches. Da'is can design virtual spaces resembling mosques or halaqahs, where participants experience religious atmospheres through visual, auditory, and participatory experiences. Da'wah messages are delivered via voice chat, text messages, and avatar interactions. From a symbolic interactionism perspective, virtual symbols such as avatar seating positions, digital greeting gestures, and space design play a role in constructing religious meaning through repeated social interactions.

Husein Basyaiban's da'wah practices on Roblox exemplify how virtual symbols and interactions build religious experiences. In one digital content instance, he organized an Islamic study session in a virtual space resembling a mosque or hall, with participants attending via their avatars. The virtual mosque functions not merely as a decorative space but as a symbol of sacred space, collectively interpreted through players' behaviors, such as orderly seating, greetings, and responses to study material. Notably, Husein implemented avatar selection policies requiring modest clothing and adherence to Shari'i norms. Within a symbolic interactionist framework, avatars, digital attire, and player gestures serve as social symbols whose meanings are negotiated. Participants' willingness to adjust their avatars reflects the internalization of etiquette and religious identity through roleplay and social interaction in digital spaces.

Similar phenomena are found in Malaysian Muslim communities that utilize Roblox to conduct virtual Qur'an study sessions, involving children and adults. From the mediatization of religion perspective, religious practices previously occurring in physical spaces are now mediated by avatars, virtual mosques, and digital communication, creating inclusive and immersive spiritual experiences. Media not only conveys teachings but also reshapes the way religiosity is experienced and expressed. Academically, da'wah on Roblox can be understood through two main frameworks. Symbolic interactionism explains how religious meaning is constructed through avatar symbols and interactions, while the mediatization of religion demonstrates how media logic shapes the practice of da'wah itself. Thus, da'wah on Roblox represents an interactive, participatory religious experience aligned with the digital culture of Generations Z and Alpha.



3. Da'wah Strategies on Roblox

Da'wah strategies on the Roblox platform can be analyzed through theoretical approaches in communication and digital da'wah studies that emphasize participation and experiential learning. The use of roleplay and map-building features to create virtual mosques, Hajj simulation spaces, and interactive study areas can be examined through gamification concepts, i.e., the application of game elements in non-game contexts to enhance user engagement (Alhasan, 2023). In da'wah, gamification allows Islamic values to be delivered in enjoyable, collaborative, and experience-based activities, facilitating more organic internalization of religious teachings. Furthermore, avatars representing Islamic identities through Shari'i-compliant attire and religious symbols can be examined using symbolic interactionism theory, which views avatars as social symbols conveying religious meaning and collective identity in digital spaces (Hidayanto, 2019).

Da'wah strategies on Roblox also manifest in real-time communication practices through chat and voice interactions, adopting a participatory communication approach. In this model, da'wah is no longer one-way, as in conventional sermons, but involves dialogue, Q&A, and interactive discussions that allow audiences to actively engage in interpreting Islamic values (Annafsa et al., 2025). This approach aligns with the characteristics of Generations Z and Alpha, accustomed to horizontal and collaborative communication. Moreover, the establishment of virtual da'wah communities, such as the Istiqblok server, indicates a shift from instructional da'wah to community-based digital da'wah. From the mediatization of religion perspective, media not only serves as a message channel but also shapes new religious experiences through technology-mediated social interaction (Usman, 2016).

Beyond the game platform itself, Roblox da'wah strategies are extended via content dissemination to social media platforms such as TikTok, Instagram, and YouTube as a form of transmedia da'wah. Activities occurring in the gaming space are transferred to other media to increase virality and reach a wider audience. This process illustrates that religious practices increasingly follow digital media logic, including algorithms, visual aesthetics, and viral culture. Academically, this strategy reflects a shift in both medium and method toward immersive experiences integrating cognitive, affective, and psychomotor aspects. Consequently, da'wah on Roblox represents innovation and novelty in contemporary da'wah practices relevant to the popular culture of Generations Z and Alpha.

4. Transmedia Dissemination of Roblox Da'wah via Social Media

Da'wah activities within Roblox do not remain confined to the game environment; instead, they are recorded and shared on social media platforms such as TikTok and Instagram in the form of short videos. The shared content typically consists of excerpts from virtual study sessions, avatar interactions, or brief dialogues that are easily consumable by digital audiences. These uploads garner widespread engagement through comments, content replication, and resharing, creating a dual audience: active Roblox players and social media users who do not directly participate in the game (Aulia, 2025). In this context, Roblox functions as the primary site of da'wah practice, while social media serves as a distribution channel that expands the reach of religious messages. Social media not only acts as a conduit for communication but also as an agent reshaping religious practices, influencing how religious content is produced, displayed, and interpreted by digital audiences. The transition of da'wah from Roblox to TikTok reflects cross-platform transmedial communication (Hepp et al., 2015).

Based on the author's analysis, da'wah activities such as virtual study sessions, joint Qur'an recitations, and simulated rituals in Roblox are recorded, edited, and then disseminated via popular platforms like TikTok, Instagram, and YouTube. Social media thus becomes a key strategy for transforming immersive virtual da'wah experiences into content accessible to wider audiences. The viral nature of Roblox da'wah content highlights the role of social media algorithms as accelerators in the dissemination of religious messages (Mazaya, 2022). From a transmedial perspective, da'wah practices migrate across media, creating new meanings that reflect the characteristics of each platform. Activities that were once exclusive to the game become more inclusive and accessible to the general public through short-form video content. Social media, therefore, bridges the virtual da'wah community with broader audiences.

The dissemination of da'wah via social media does not merely transfer Roblox content; it involves processes of reproducing and contextualizing religious messages. Creators typically edit videos by adding narration, visual text, background music, or Islamic humor to match their digital audiences' preferences. This practice aligns with the uses and gratifications theory, which emphasizes that audiences consume media to satisfy needs for entertainment, information, and identity formation (Junaedi, 2007). Roblox da'wah content circulating on social media thus serves a dual function: providing light entertainment while reinforcing Islamic values. This approach allows da'wah to adapt to popular culture without abandoning its normative dimension, ensuring the religious message remains relevant to youth familiar with short-form visual content.

Cross-platform dissemination also generates a layered audience. The primary audience consists of Roblox players directly involved in da'wah activities within the game, while the secondary audience comprises social media users who do not play Roblox but are nonetheless exposed to the da'wah content. This dual-audience model extends the impact of da'wah, as religious messages reach beyond the internal game community to the wider public, including parents who perceive this method as better aligned with the digital world of youth (Zamhari, 2025). However, this strategy also faces challenges, such as the risk of commodifying da'wah, algorithmic bias favoring light content, and potential negative comments or disruptions of intended meaning. Therefore, narrative management and

digital moderation become critical components of the dissemination strategy.

From an academic perspective, the dissemination of Roblox da'wah through social media represents a transmedia da'wah model, in which religious messages migrate from participatory spaces to visual-consumptive spaces. This practice illustrates the transformation of da'wah methods alongside changes in media consumption patterns of digital generations. Practically, the strategy underscores the importance of collaboration among young creators, virtual communities, and da'wah institutions to produce content that is educational, engaging, and high-quality. Within the symbolic interactionist framework, religious symbols such as hijab-wearing avatars, virtual mosques, and congregational interactions are redefined when reproduced in short video formats. The meaning of da'wah is constructed not only by the primary actors but also negotiated through social media audience responses.

Based on the above discussion, da'wah practices on Roblox can be categorized as game-based da'wah, i.e., the strategy of delivering Islamic values through interactive, immersive digital gaming. Digital entertainment spaces function as new arenas for religiosity, visual, collaborative, and experience-based. From the perspective of the mediatization of religion, da'wah, which is originally deep and participatory, becomes subject to social media logic such as speed, visual aesthetics, and viral culture, while simultaneously expanding message reach. This transformation demonstrates how religion adapts to digital media logic, making Roblox da'wah a form of mediated religiosity relevant to the cultures of Generations Z and Alpha.

5. Audience Interaction and Response in Virtual Da'wah

Interaction between da'i (preachers) and their audience is a crucial element in the effectiveness of da'wah, as it determines the extent to which religious messages are understood, accepted, and internalized (Bashori, 2022). In virtual game-based environments such as Roblox, these interactions undergo significant transformations, shifting from conventional verbal communication to digital interactions mediated by avatars, text, voice, and collaborative in-game actions. This change in medium gives rise to a digital da'wah dynamic that differs markedly from traditional religious gatherings. In virtual spaces, da'i and audiences, primarily children and adolescents, interact in a more fluid, egalitarian, and participatory atmosphere. The audience no longer functions as passive listeners but as active participants in social-religious simulations. Through dialogues, Q&A sessions, and avatar-based responses, da'wah enables emotional engagement and simultaneous reflection on value, allowing Islamic teachings to be conveyed through an interactive experience rather than unidirectional lectures.

The digital da'wah practice conducted by Husein Basyaiban on Roblox exemplifies this transformation of da'wah interaction. Through the Istiqblok community (Ikatan Server Taat Istiqomah Qalbu Roblox), Husein organizes Islamic study sessions in virtual spaces modeled after mosques or study halls. Participants attend as avatars, sit attentively during the study, and engage in discussions via chat and voice features. Notably, Husein enforces digital etiquette rules, such as requiring avatars to wear modest clothing in compliance with shari'i norms before entering the study space. These rules are not merely technical game requirements but function as symbolic mechanisms for internalizing moral values. In

this practice, da'wah interaction becomes multidimensional, encompassing educational, emotional, and spiritual aspects integrated into the gaming experience.

Audience responses to Roblox da'wah indicate high levels of enthusiasm, as documented in videos uploaded to TikTok and other social media platforms. These videos capture the atmosphere of virtual study sessions, dialogues between Husein and participants, and audience participation. Comment sections are filled with appreciation, including feedback from parents who perceive game-based da'wah as more relevant to youth culture. These responses suggest that contextual da'wah aligned with the digital habits of Generations Z and Alpha can significantly enhance audience interest and engagement. Furthermore, cross-platform content dissemination extends the reach of da'wah beyond spatial and temporal boundaries, allowing interactions to continue in broader public discourse on social media.

Within Roblox, audience engagement extends beyond listening to lectures, developing into interactive discussions and symbolic practices. Players frequently ask religious questions via chat, respond to da'wah content with emoticons, or share personal reflections. Observable changes in digital behavior include modifying avatars' clothing to more Islamic attire, using greetings in communication, and avoiding inappropriate language. Such behaviors reflect the contextual internalization of Islamic values through social experiences in the game. Religious values are absorbed not doctrinally but through symbolic habituation and enjoyable interactions. Roblox thus functions as a practical da'wah space, enabling the direct application of values in players' everyday virtual lives.

Roblox also provides an emotionally engaging and participatory learning experience, which is critical for effective religious education (Azzahra, 2025). Players do not merely acquire cognitive understanding of the material but associate Islamic values with positive experiences, such as being accepted in the community, being appreciated for proper etiquette, and feeling close to a non-judgmental, relatable da'i (Fatimah, 2025). According to affective learning theory, emotional dimensions play a key role in long-term learning, particularly for children and adolescents (Ulfah, 2024). Husein's presence as a young, communicative, and relatable da'i serves as an emotional bridge, strengthening young audiences' spiritual attachment to the Islamic values conveyed.

The phenomenon of da'wah interaction on Roblox can be analyzed through the frameworks of symbolic interactionism and mediatization of religion. From a symbolic interactionist perspective, avatars, digital clothing, virtual gestures, and etiquette rules serve as symbols collectively interpreted and negotiated by players. Changes in avatar behavior reflect the process of constructing meaning for religious values through social interaction. Meanwhile, mediatization of religion explains how religious experiences are shaped by the logic of digital platforms and social media. Da'wah content recorded and disseminated on TikTok is shaped by algorithms, visual aesthetics, and viral culture, meaning that religion is not only delivered through media but also reshaped by it. Symbolic interaction within the game and social media mediation operate simultaneously, producing a new form of participatory, visual, and distributed religiosity.

D. CONCLUSION

Da'wah practices on online game platforms such as Roblox represent a significant

transformation of digital da'wah, demonstrating relevance to the culture of Generations Z and Alpha. The concept of game-based da'wah indicates that religious preaching is no longer confined to physical spaces or one-way lecture formats. Instead, it manifests as an immersive, participatory, and collaborative experience facilitated through digital game mechanics. Through simulations, roleplay, avatar use, and the formation of virtual communities, Islamic values are delivered and experienced directly by audiences within contexts that mirror their daily digital lives. This approach reinforces participatory da'wah, wherein audiences are not merely objects but active subjects in the meaning-making and internalization of religious teachings. The use of Roblox by young da'i, such as Husein Basyaiban, through the Istiqblok community demonstrates that digital entertainment spaces can serve as new, educational, inclusive, and contextually relevant religious arenas. Interaction between da'i and audiences, mediated through avatars, visual symbols, and real-time communication, creates a fluid and egalitarian da'wah dynamic. From the perspective of symbolic interactionism, virtual symbols such as digital mosques, avatar clothing, and religious gestures serve as tools for collectively negotiated religious meaning. Meanwhile, the mediatization of religion framework explains how da'wah is not only transmitted through media but also shaped by digital platform logic, algorithms, and viral culture. Beyond in-game interactions, Roblox da'wah is further disseminated through transmedia to social media platforms such as TikTok and Instagram. This strategy broadens the reach of da'wah and generates a dual audience, though it also introduces challenges such as commodification and oversimplification of messages. Overall, game-based online da'wah demonstrates that virtuality does not diminish spirituality but rather opens new opportunities to develop adaptive, creative, and media-congruent da'wah theories and practices in contemporary digital ecosystems.

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AUTHOR CONTRIBUTIONS

- Author 1 : Developed a descriptive qualitative approach to evaluate youth da'wah patterns, combining participatory observation, interviews, and field documentation within a modern social context.
- Author 2 : Conducted YouTube content analysis, interactive observation, and systematic measurement of young audience engagement.
- Author 3 : Integrated online content analysis and documentation of religious activities.



- Author 4 : Combined digital ethnography, interactive observation, and thematic coding to assess da'wah communication strategies.
- Author 5 : Merged interactive observation, data triangulation, and thematic coding to understand the effectiveness of virtual da'wah strategies.

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